

Portfolio report: 2026-10-04 (Sunday)

Prices as of the Friday 2026-10-02 close (US Eastern). News window: Thursday 2026-10-01 after the close through Sunday 2026-10-04. This is your first report, so each holding also gets a short "how it got here" background.

Your orders have not filled yet. All 16 rows in your trade log are market orders dated Monday 2026-10-05. The "entry price" in the sheet is Friday's closing price, used as an estimate. Your real prices will be Monday's opening prices, so every profit-or-loss figure below is \$0.00 for now. Today's Lesson of the day explains why.

The bottom line

- **Quiet weekend, big Friday.** Friday's gains came mostly from **groups of stocks rising together**, not from company news. No company released results or major business news between Thursday's close and today. Only two index changes (Moderna, FormFactor) and Snowflake's bond paperwork came out.
- **Why the groups rose:** the whole market rose because a weak US jobs report made an interest-rate rise less likely [Motley Fool, 2026-10-02](#). Higher rates tend to push share prices down, so a smaller chance of a rise helped. Chip stocks continued a late-September rally; no single new cause was published (inference, medium confidence). AAOI and VIAV are exceptions: more than half of their moves were their own, with no reason published. Even so, those company-only parts were within each stock's normal range.
- **Your money: \$197.35 planned across 16 stocks; profit or loss so far \$0.00** because nothing has filled. About \$6 of every \$10 rides on one story, AI data-center spending (62.3%), and 78.3% is in technology companies (data/metrics/portfolio-2026-10-04.json).
- **Rules:** three stocks moved more than your 5% "explain this" line on Friday: AAOI +7.7%, STRL +5.6%, VIAV +5.2%. None had company news. STRL's move was mostly the market and its industry. For AAOI and VIAV, half or more of the move was not explained by the market or chip stocks. Optical peers also rose, which may explain part of it (inference, medium). **No stop-loss or target can fire yet** because your sheet has no stop or target prices. (A stop-loss is a price you write down in advance as "tell me if it falls this far"; a target is the matching price on the way up.)
- **No THESIS ALERT, but three borderline matches.** Your thesis is your written reason for owning a stock. Your "breaker" list in `config/rules.toml` names events that would make you re-check that reason; finding one raises a THESIS ALERT. One breaker is a large share sale reported under "8-K Item 3.02" (the part of an 8-K used to report new shares issued privately). Three companies filed one: AMD (new shares to pay for World Labs, about 0.8% more shares), Snowflake (bonds that can turn into about 2.2% more shares, up to about 4%, only if the price rises about 42–47% from Friday) and Moderna (bonds that can turn into about 3.6% more shares if the price passes \$210.58, only about 11% above Friday). Your rule says "large" but sets no size. The report did not call any of them large, because none is a sale of shares for cash and each is under about 5%. If you want a fixed line, you can write a percentage into `config/rules.toml`. Separately, VIAV had unplanned insider selling in August–September that would have met your breaker at the time (see its section).
- **Coming up:** the deep dive on your biggest position, ASML, is ready (reports/deep-dives/ASML-2026-10-04.md). ASML reports results on 2026-10-14, TSMC on 2026-10-15.

Your rules today

These are your own rules from *config/rules.toml* and your sheet. The report shows which fired and the evidence both ways, never a buy or sell call: the decision, and the knowledge of your whole situation, are yours.

Stock	Status	Why
AAOI	WATCH	Up 7.71% on Friday, more than your 5% line. No company news; optical-networking stocks rose as a group (explained below).
STRL	WATCH	Up 5.6% on Friday, more than your 5% line. No company news; the whole market and construction stocks rose after the weak jobs report.
VIAV	WATCH	Up 5.18% on Friday, more than your 5% line. No company news; the 13th higher close in a row, alongside optical peers. Past unplanned insider selling (Aug-Sep) would have met your breaker at the time; see below.
AMD	No rule fired	Borderline breaker match: 8-K Item 3.02 (2026-09-28): new shares to pay about \$8.2B for World Labs, about 0.8% more shares; not a sale for cash (source 1 below).
SNOW	No rule fired	Borderline breaker match: 8-K Item 3.02 (2026-10-02): \$3.75B of bonds that can turn into about 2.2% more shares (up to about 4%), only if the price rises about 42–47% from Friday; a hedge limits it (source 2 below).
MRNA	No rule fired	Borderline breaker match: 8-K Item 3.02 (2026-09-01): \$3.0B of bonds that can turn into about 3.6% more shares above about \$210.58, only about 11% above Friday (source 3 below). Also 8-K Item 5.02 (2026-09-30): a new Chief Operating Officer starts 2026-10-05 and the head of manufacturing and quality is retiring. Your breaker is about the chief executive (CEO) or chief financial officer (CFO) leaving unexpectedly; both stay, so it is not met (source 4 below).
ASML, CRWD, CRDO, LITE, TSM, PANW, BE, A, AXTI, FORM	No rule fired	No move over 5%, no stop or target set in your sheet.

Sources for the table:

- (1) AMD: [SEC 8-K, 2026-09-28](#)
- (2) SNOW: [SEC 8-K, 2026-10-02](#)
- (3) MRNA: [SEC 8-K, 2026-09-01](#)
- (4) MRNA: [SEC 8-K, 2026-09-30](#)

Not checkable yet: your **stop-loss** and **target** rules use columns S and T of your sheet, which are empty for every trade, so they cannot fire. The max-loss, trailing, long-trend and concentration rules are switched off in `config/rules.toml`.

Position: ASML (ASML Holding)

Bottom line: ASML, your largest position (13.2%), rose 3.25% on Friday with no company news, mostly because chip stocks rallied. Its biggest test is the 2026-10-14 results; thesis check: no breaker found against the company's own plan (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.014 shares at about \$1,867.31 (Friday's close, the sheet's estimate), worth \$26.14; not filled yet, so \$0.00 profit or loss. Friday +3.25%. The stock is 6.6% below its 52-week high (its highest price in the past year) of \$1,999.96. It is in an uptrend, meaning it trades above its 50- and 200-day moving averages [average prices over those periods]. A typical day moves it about 2.7% (`data/metrics/2026-10-04.json`).

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* this split (called "attribution") divides each day's move into three parts: the whole market, the stock's industry, and the company itself. Of Friday's +3.25%, about +0.58 points came from the whole market, +1.38 from chip stocks in general, and +1.30 from ASML itself. That company part is a normal-sized amount for this stock (`attribution-2026-10-04.json`).

- Chip stocks rallied broadly on Friday (Arm +8%, AMD +3%, NVIDIA +2%); no ASML announcement or filing appeared [24/7 Wall St., 2026-10-02](#).
- Background: in July ASML raised its 2026 sales forecast to €43–45 billion [ASML Q2 2026 results \(6-K\), 2026-07-15](#), from €36–40 billion in April [ASML Q1 2026 results \(6-K\), 2026-04-15](#), after Q2 sales of €9.33 billion beat the €8.80 billion analysts expected [Investing.com \(Reuters\), 2026-07-15](#).
- Open risk: a proposed US law, the MATCH Act, could stop ASML selling older machines to China and servicing those already there. It is not law. Its status could not be confirmed beyond low-tier reports (tier 3: secondary press, the least reliable kind of source we use) [NL Times, 2026-08-20](#).

How this works ASML builds the "projectors" that print circuit patterns onto silicon. These are called lithography machines. Its top machines use extreme ultraviolet (EUV) light, and nobody else sells them. Customers are a handful of chipmakers. Four of them made up 61.2% of 2025 sales, and China was 29.1% [ASML 20-F, 2026-02-25](#). It sold 48 EUV systems in 2025, up from 44 in 2024. A quarter of its sales is servicing and upgrading machines already installed, which is steadier money. Full analysis: the deep dive.

Case to stay

1. Sole supplier of EUV machines; 2025 sales €32.7 billion (+15.6%) with a 52.8% gross margin [ASML 20-F, 2026-02-25](#).
2. Forecast raised twice this year, to €43–45 billion for 2026, with capacity for 2027 planned about 30% higher [ASML Q2 2026 results \(6-K\), 2026-07-15](#).
3. Net cash (more cash than debt) and a falling share count (buybacks [the company buying back its own shares]), so it has little need to raise money (deep dive, Section 5.3).

Case to retreat

1. The price assumes a lot. Investors pay about 60 times the last 12 months' profit, against 34–37 times at

each of the last four year-ends. If it went back to that range with profits unchanged, the price would be about 40% lower (deep dive, Verdict and Section 7; our calculation, not a forecast).

2. China is expected to be about 20% of 2026 sales (management, via Reuters) [Investing.com, 2026-07-15](#). The MATCH Act would cut off part of that: older DUV (deep ultraviolet) machines and servicing for major Chinese chipmakers. How much is not disclosed, and its status is unconfirmed (tier-3 reports).
3. Chip-equipment demand is cyclical: it rises and falls in waves as chipmakers build, then pause. Morgan Stanley reportedly (single tier-3 source) trimmed its price target [the price an analyst expects in about a year], worried that China demand and margins could disappoint [ad-hoc-news, 2026-09-10](#).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/ASML.md); judged against ASML's own plan, nothing contradicts it.

Coming up Q3 results on 2026-10-14, before the US open (MarketBeat and search results agree; ASML's page could not be opened). The company expects €11.0–12.0 billion of sales and a 55–57% gross margin.

Position: PANW (Palo Alto Networks)

Bottom line: PANW rose 1.76% on Friday to a record area with no material news; most of the past week's +7.6% came from cybersecurity stocks rising together. Thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.050 shares at about \$403.24, worth \$20.16; not filled yet. Friday +1.76%. It is 1.5% below its 52-week high (\$409.50) and in an uptrend; a typical day moves it about 4.3%.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +1.76%, +0.75 points came from the market, +0.22 from cybersecurity stocks and +0.80 from PANW itself (normal size).

- TD Cowen raised its price target to \$440 from \$400 and kept a Buy rating. That is an opinion, not new facts [Investing.com, 2026-10-02](#).
- Director Lee Klarich gave away 25,000 shares as a gift (not a sale) [SEC Form 4, 2026-10-01](#).
- Background: on 2026-09-14 security stocks jumped (PANW about +13%) after AI-lab leaders warned about the risks of powerful AI, which investors read as more security spending ahead [Forbes, 2026-09-14](#).

How this works Palo Alto sells security for company networks, cloud systems and logins, mostly as subscriptions. Its key number is next-generation security ARR (annual recurring revenue \[the yearly value of subscriptions customers are signed up for\]). It reached \$9.10 billion, up 63% [PANW Q4 FY2026 results, 2026-09-01](#). Part of that growth was bought: it acquired CyberArk (logins and passwords for people and AI agents) in February [Palo Alto Networks, 2026-02-11](#), for \$21.1 billion, partly with 112 million new shares [PANW 10-Q, 2026-06-02](#).

Case to stay

1. Revenue \$3.41 billion in the quarter (+34%), above forecasts; next year's forecast \$14.10–14.20 billion [PANW Q4 FY2026 results, 2026-09-01](#).
2. New AI-security services launched, such as Unit 42 Frontier AI Defense [Palo Alto Networks, 2026-09-22](#).
3. Apart from one small director sale (about \$0.1 million) outside a plan, insider sales were pre-planned; no lawsuits or customer losses found (research file).

Case to retreat

1. The price is high. Investors pay about 96–97 times next year's expected adjusted profit per share (our

calculation from company guidance: \$403.24 / \$4.16–4.19).

2. Bernstein downgraded it (lowered its rating) on 2026-09-18, saying the stock had run past fair value [Motley Fool, 2026-09-18](#).
3. The company expects growth to slow from 34% to 23–24% next year, because the one-time boost from buying CyberArk fades. Under standard accounting it also lost money last quarter (–\$0.35 a share) [PANW Q4 FY2026 results, 2026-09-01](#).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/PANW.md); nothing contradicts the company's plan.

Coming up Q1 FY2027 results (FY is the fiscal year, the company's own accounting year), estimated mid-to-late November (not confirmed). Company guidance: revenue \$3.300–3.310 billion.

Position: CRWD (CrowdStrike)

Bottom line: CRWD rose 1.48% on Friday with the market and security stocks; the only company news was large insider sales, all on pre-planned schedules. Thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.074 shares at about \$270.04, worth \$19.98; not filled yet. Friday +1.48%. 1.3% below its 52-week high (\$273.54), in an uptrend; up 130% this year; a typical day moves it about 4.2%.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +1.48%, +0.95 points came from the market, +0.26 from cybersecurity stocks and +0.27 from CrowdStrike itself (normal size). The past week's +7.1% was almost all the cybersecurity group (+7.0 points).

- President Michael Sentonas sold about \$64.2 million of shares (about 16% of his direct stake) under a 10b5-1 plan adopted 2026-07-01 [SEC Form 4, 2026-10-02](#).
- Across the filings window insiders sold about \$210 million, all pre-planned, and bought nothing; the largest was the chief financial officer's roughly \$125.5 million on 2026-09-24 [SEC Form 4, 2026-09-25](#).
- Background: CrowdStrike put its Falcon platform on the OpenAI Marketplace, so OpenAI business customers can pay for it from their OpenAI budgets [CrowdStrike, 2026-09-29](#).

How this works CrowdStrike sells "Falcon", security software that watches companies' laptops, servers, cloud systems and logins for attacks. Customers pay yearly subscriptions and add modules over time. "Falcon Flex" lets them prepay a budget and switch modules on later, like a gift card for a whole mall: accounts using Flex make up over \$2.29 billion of ARR, up 101%. Total ARR was \$5.84 billion (+25%) and quarterly revenue \$1.47 billion (+26%) [CrowdStrike Q2 FY2027 results, 2026-08-26](#). The 4-for-1 stock split in July is why today's price (about \$270) looks lower than older articles' \$400-plus prices.

Case to stay

1. Record net new ARR of \$332.8 million (+51%), and results beat forecasts [CrowdStrike Q2 FY2027 results, 2026-08-26](#).
2. Full-year revenue forecast raised to \$5,991–6,011 million; free cash flow \$377.4 million last quarter (same release).
3. New sales channels for AI customers, e.g. the OpenAI Marketplace [CrowdStrike, 2026-09-29](#).

Case to retreat

1. Expensive: about 39–50 times yearly sales (Zacks and Trefis, tier 3, unverified), and the average analyst target (\$235.67) is below Friday's close [StockAnalysis, 2026-10-02](#).
2. Thin standard (GAAP) profit: \$5.3 million last quarter, or 1 cent a share. The company's "adjusted"

figure, which leaves some costs out, was 31 cents (results release above).

3. Top managers sold about \$210 million in a few weeks after the stock more than doubled; all were pre-planned, so not your breaker, but none bought.

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/CRWD.md); the starting points suggested in that file (ARR growth) are holding: ARR grew 25%.

Coming up Q3 FY2027 results in early December (estimated, not confirmed). Company guidance: revenue \$1,523.2–1,529.2 million, adjusted EPS \$0.31.

Position: LITE (Lumentum)

Bottom line: LITE closed at a record \$1,085.42 (+3.79%) on Friday, mostly because chip and optical stocks rose. The week's +15% followed new Wall Street coverage and an optics rally; thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.018 shares at about \$1,085.42, worth \$19.54; not filled yet. Friday +3.79%; up 539% over a year. A typical day moves it about 6.1%, and its worst fall in the past year was 42.8%.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +3.79%, +0.37 points came from the market, +2.29 from chip stocks and +1.13 from Lumentum itself (normal size).

- The CFO sold 24,542 shares (about \$25.7 million, roughly a quarter of his stake) under a pre-planned 10b5-1 plan, a schedule set months ahead, so it says little about his view today [SEC Form 4, 2026-10-02](#).
- On Thursday the stock jumped 7.7% as optical stocks rallied. The trigger was Bernstein starting to cover the group at Outperform (an analyst label meaning "expected to do better than similar stocks") (note dated 2026-09-30; exact release time unconfirmed) [Yahoo Finance, 2026-10-01](#).
- Background: last quarter's revenue doubled to \$1.01 billion (+109%) [Lumentum Q4 FY2026 results, 2026-08-11](#).

How this works Inside AI data centers, thousands of chips must talk to each other. Over longer distances that happens with light through glass fibre. Lumentum makes the lasers and optical parts that turn electrical signals into light, plus switches that steer light (optical circuit switches). Buyers are module makers and cloud giants. Two customers were 41.6% of last year's revenue (10-K, per research file). Unit sales are not disclosed.

Case to stay

1. Revenue more than doubled and next quarter is guided to \$1.225–1.275 billion [Lumentum Q4 FY2026 results, 2026-08-11](#).
2. Management said on its earnings call it is still shipping behind customer demand for its lasers (tier 3 transcript) [Investing.com, 2026-08-11](#).
3. Possible US limits on Chinese optical parts could help US makers (draft rules and a Senate bill, not law) [Sen. McCormick, 2026-09-15](#).

Case to retreat

1. Very jumpy: it fell 9.9% on 2026-09-14 and lost 42.8% at its worst point in the past year (data/metrics).
2. Two customers are 41.6% of revenue, so one customer's plans can swing results.
3. Lumentum swapped convertible bonds (loans that the lender can later exchange for shares) for about 10.6 million new shares. That raised the share count by about 13% last quarter. It removed debt but diluted owners [Lumentum 10-K, 2026-08-14](#). The price is also about 31 times yearly sales (GuruFocus, tier 3, unverified).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/LITE.md).

Coming up OCP (Open Compute Project) Global Summit, a data-center hardware conference, 2026-10-12 to 10-15 (Lumentum talks 10-14, confirmed). Q1 FY2027 results estimated early November (not announced).

Position: MRNA (Moderna)

Bottom line: Moderna is up 544% this year because a cancer-vaccine trial succeeded, and the next big test is the full trial data on 2026-10-24 (Thesis: Watch). It also joins the Nasdaq-100 index on 2026-10-09, which forces index funds to buy shares but changes nothing in the business.

Where it stands Order for 0.100 shares at about \$190.01, worth \$19.00; not filled yet. Friday +0.57%. 9% below its 52-week high (\$208.90). Very jumpy: a typical day moves it about 7.1%.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +0.57%, +1.36 points came from the market, -2.41 from biotech stocks and +1.61 from Moderna itself (normal size for this stock).

- Nasdaq said Moderna joins the Nasdaq-100 (a list of the 100 largest non-financial companies on the Nasdaq exchange) before the open on 2026-10-09, replacing Warner Bros. Discovery. Index funds copy that list automatically, so they must buy Moderna shares [Nasdaq, 2026-10-01](#).
- Citi downgraded the stock to Sell on 2026-09-30. It argued the price already assumes about \$13 billion a year of cancer-vaccine sales [CNBC, 2026-09-30](#).
- Background: on 2026-08-19 Moderna and Merck said their personalised melanoma vaccine (intismeran) plus Merck's Keytruda met its main goal in a large Phase 3 trial (the final round of patient testing before approval). The stock rose 177% that day [Moderna/Merck, 2026-08-19](#).

How this works Moderna's mRNA medicines give the body instructions to make a protein, here one that trains the immune system to recognise a patient's own tumour. Each vaccine is made for one patient from their tumour's genetic code. Moderna and Merck share costs and profits 50/50. It is not sold yet, so sales are "not available". Today Moderna mostly sells COVID vaccines and lost money: revenue \$145 million and a net loss of \$0.8 billion last quarter [Moderna Q2 2026 results, 2026-07-31](#).

Case to stay

1. A successful Phase 3 cancer trial (the last stage before approval) is rare and could open a large new market [Moderna/Merck, 2026-08-19](#).
2. The US Food and Drug Administration (FDA) approved its mRNA flu vaccine, mFLUSIVA, for adults 50+ [NBC News, 2026-08-05](#).
3. It raised \$3.0 billion in September, so cash is not an immediate worry [SEC 8-K, 2026-09-01](#).

Case to retreat

1. The price rests on future cancer sales; today the company loses money. If the 2026-10-24 data disappoint, the stock can fall hard (it fell about 25% the day after its 177% jump).
2. The September bonds are convertible: they can turn into about 14 million new shares (about 3.6% more) if the price passes about \$210.58, only about 11% above Friday. A hedge called a capped call offsets that up to about \$392.62. A capped call is a side deal with banks that hands Moderna back shares as the price rises, cancelling out the new shares up to a ceiling price [SEC 8-K, 2026-09-01](#).
3. Citi sees the stock falling to \$80 [CNBC, 2026-09-30](#).

Thesis check Watch - no written thesis yet (theses/MRNA.md). Not because something broke: the value now hangs on one upcoming data release.

Coming up Joins Nasdaq-100 on 2026-10-09 (confirmed). Full melanoma data at the European Society for Medical Oncology (ESMO) cancer conference on 2026-10-24 (confirmed). Q3 results about 2026-10-29 (estimated).

Position: TSM (Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing)

Bottom line: TSM rose 2.96% on Friday, mostly because chip stocks rallied. A Bloomberg report said TSMC is weighing a large new Texas factory campus, which the company would not confirm; thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.030 shares at about \$472.78, worth \$14.18; not filled yet. Friday +2.96%. 1.3% below its 52-week high; uptrend; a calm stock for this portfolio (typical day 2.2%).

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +2.96%, +0.85 points came from the market, +0.98 from chip stocks and +1.12 from TSMC itself (normal size).

- TSMC is weighing a multi-factory campus near Dallas, each factory costing at least \$20 billion. The plan is at an early stage, and TSMC said "no comment on market rumors" [Bloomberg, 2026-10-01](#).
- Background: August sales were a record NT\$514.81 billion (New Taiwan dollars), up 53.3% from a year earlier [TSMC, 2026-09-10](#).

How this works TSMC is a contract chipmaker (a foundry): companies like NVIDIA, AMD and Apple design chips, and TSMC manufactures them. It is like a printing house that prints other people's books, but the presses cost billions. It earns more on the newest, smallest designs ("advanced nodes"). Last quarter revenue was US\$40.20 billion (+36%) with a 67.7% gross margin [TSMC Q2 2026 results, 2026-07-16](#).

Case to stay

1. Monthly sales at records, driven by AI chips [TSMC, 2026-09-10](#).
2. Very high margins and the leading position in advanced chipmaking [TSMC Q2 2026 results, 2026-07-16](#).
3. No insider sales; no downgrades or guidance cuts found (research file).

Case to retreat

1. Q3 gross margin guided lower (65–67% vs 67.7%) because new 2-nanometre factories cost more at first (same release).
2. Factory spending is heavy, and a new Texas campus would add more. A US decision on chip tariffs (import taxes) is also pending (tier-3 reports only).
3. Taiwan's political situation is a risk. Spreading money across many stocks cannot remove that risk from this one company, because most of its factories are in Taiwan (inference, high confidence).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/TSM.md).

Coming up September sales on 2026-10-08; Q3 results on 2026-10-15 (2:00 a.m. US Eastern, confirmed). Company guidance: revenue US\$44.6–45.8 billion.

Position: STRL (Sterling Infrastructure)

Bottom line: STRL jumped 5.6% on Friday (your 5% rule fired) without company news, because the whole market and construction stocks rose after a weak jobs report, and STRL usually moves about three times as much as the market. It is still 47% below its June high; thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis

yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.019 shares at about \$533.42, worth \$10.13; not filled yet. Friday +5.6%; a typical day moves it about 5%. It peaked at \$1,005.68 on 2026-06-04 and fell 54% at its worst; it is now in a short-term bounce inside a longer downtrend.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +5.6%, about +2.25 points came from the market, +1.96 from US infrastructure-construction stocks and +1.39 from Sterling itself, a normal amount for this stock. So the big move was mostly "everything went up, and STRL goes up more".

- The US added only 29,000 jobs in September (tier-3 report; no page from the Bureau of Labor Statistics, the official source, was read) and unemployment rose to 4.2%. A weaker job market makes the central bank less likely to raise interest rates. So traders cut their bets on an October rate rise, the S&P 500 (an index of 500 large US companies) rose about 0.7%, and industrial stocks led [Motley Fool, 2026-10-02](#).
- Background: in August Sterling beat forecasts and raised its 2026 outlook to \$4.00–4.15 billion of revenue. Yet the stock fell 13% after hours (in trading after the 4 p.m. close). The researcher's explanation (inference, medium confidence) is that the extra revenue comes at lower profit margins, partly from an acquired firm [Sterling Q2 2026 results, 2026-08-03](#).

How this works Sterling prepares the ground for big buildings: clearing, grading, foundations, concrete and utilities, mostly for data centers and factories. It is paid per project, so its "backlog" (signed work not yet done) shows future revenue: \$4.33 billion signed, up 116% [Sterling Q2 2026 results, 2026-08-03](#).

Case to stay

1. Revenue \$1.168 billion (+90%) and the 2026 outlook raised (same release).
2. Backlog more than doubled, which shows work lined up for the coming year (same release).
3. No downgrades, lawsuits or share sales found in the past week (research file).

Case to retreat

1. Data centers are most of the growth, so a slowdown in AI building would hit it directly (inference, medium confidence).
2. It moves about three times as much as the market (beta 3.29, data/metrics); down 54% at its worst this year (data/metrics).
3. In May 2026 Sterling made a shelf filing (S-3). That is a registration which lets it sell new shares quickly whenever it chooses. None has happened, but the stock fell 8.3% the week it was filed (tier 3) [QuiverQuant, 2026-05-18](#).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/STRL.md).

Coming up Q3 results in early November (not confirmed; estimates 2026-11-02 to 11-09).

Position: SNOW (Snowflake)

Bottom line: SNOW slipped 0.28% on Friday, after a filing confirmed it raised \$3.75 billion by selling bonds that can later turn into shares (news first announced on 2026-09-28). Thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.030 shares at about \$341.04, worth \$10.23; not filled yet. Friday -0.28%. 11% below its 52-week high; uptrend; up 125% in six months and about 188% from its April low of \$118.30.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's -0.28%, +0.76 points came from the market,

−0.78 from software stocks and −0.26 from Snowflake itself (normal size).

- Snowflake closed the sale of \$3.75 billion of 0% convertible notes. These are loans that pay no interest (0%) and that lenders can swap for shares. \$2.0 billion must be repaid in 2029 and turns into shares at about \$500.38. \$1.75 billion must be repaid in 2031 and turns into shares at about \$483.98. Lenders accept 0% because the share swap could pay off. A capped call hedge (see Moderna above) offsets dilution up to \$820.30 a share [SEC 8-K, 2026-10-02](#).
- Background: last quarter product revenue grew 37% and adjusted profit beat forecasts, so the stock jumped 22% [Snowflake Q2 FY2027 results, 2026-09-02](#).

How this works Snowflake stores companies' data in the cloud and lets them analyse it. Customers pay for the computing they use, like a taxi meter, so more AI work on their data means more billing. Its new AI tools drove about half of the recent speed-up, the company says (research file).

Case to stay

1. Three quarters in a row of faster growth; product revenue \$1,491.9 million (+37%) [Snowflake Q2 FY2027 results, 2026-09-02](#).
2. Customers spend more each year: net revenue retention 126% (same release).
3. The new bonds carry 0% interest and the hedge limits dilution (8-K above).

Case to retreat

1. Contracted future revenue slipped from \$9.21 billion to \$9.00 billion in the quarter (research file, from company releases). Under standard accounting it also lost \$191.7 million last quarter (research file, from the Q2 release).
2. If the bonds convert, there would be about 2.2% more shares. The most is about 4%, if buyers also use their option to buy extra notes (researcher's calculation from the 8-K). There was also one small unplanned insider sale by the chief revenue officer (CRO), about \$0.25 million on 2026-09-23 (research file).
3. A securities class action (a group lawsuit by shareholders who say the company misled them) is pending. Snowflake's request to dismiss it is due 2026-10-13 (10-Q, per research file).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/SNOW.md).

Coming up Court deadline 2026-10-13; Q3 FY2027 results 2026-12-02 (not confirmed on Snowflake's site). Company guidance: product revenue \$1,588–1,593 million.

Position: BE (Bloom Energy)

Bottom line: BE rose 4.17% on Friday because fuel-cell stocks rallied as a group; Bloom's own part of the move was slightly negative. Two older risks matter more: Oracle's "force majeure" notice (a claim that events outside its control excuse a delay) on Bloom's biggest project, and a shareholder lawsuit (Thesis: Watch).

Where it stands Order for 0.030 shares at about \$289.15, worth \$8.67; not filled yet. Friday +4.17%. 17.7% below its 52-week high; very jumpy (typical day 7.2%, worst fall in a year 52.7%).

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +4.17%, +1.65 points came from the market, +4.23 from clean-energy stocks and −1.71 from Bloom itself (normal noise).

- Trade press linked the rally to Virginia's new energy plan (tier 3). Virginia's 2026 Energy Plan names fuel cells as a near-term option for clean power, but does not name Bloom [Cardinal News, 2026-10-01](#).

Fuel-cell stocks rallied on Friday (FuelCell Energy +7%; tier 3) [24/7 Wall St., 2026-10-02](#).

- Barclays raised its target to \$308 and kept an Equal-Weight (neutral) rating, citing a second factory in Fremont, California [Investing.com, 2026-10-02](#).
- Background: on 2026-09-24 Oracle invoked force majeure on Project Jupiter in New Mexico. It did so because the gas pipeline for the site slipped to February 2027. The project may use up to 2.45 gigawatts of Bloom fuel cells (a gigawatt is a billion watts, roughly one large power station). All sides say the contract stands [CNBC, 2026-09-24](#).

How this works Bloom's fuel cells turn natural gas into electricity on site, without burning it, like a big battery that never runs out while gas flows. Data centers buy them because the power grid cannot connect them fast enough. Last quarter revenue was \$1,065.4 million, up 165.5%, with \$226.4 million of operating cash flow (cash brought in by the day-to-day business) [Bloom Q2 2026 results, 2026-07-28](#).

Case to stay

1. Revenue up 165.5% and the 2026 outlook raised to \$3.9–4.2 billion (same release).
2. Demand from AI data centers and utilities (Ameren plans 500 megawatts, half a gigawatt, of fuel cells, per Barclays' note) [Investing.com, 2026-10-02](#).
3. Oracle, Blue Owl and Bloom all say the Jupiter contract remains in force [CNBC, 2026-09-24](#).

Case to retreat

1. Its biggest project is delayed, and the gas pipeline will not arrive before February 2027 (same CNBC report).
2. Shareholders filed a securities class action on 2026-07-30. It followed a Hunterbrook report on Chinese scandium (a rare metal) in Bloom's supply chain, which Bloom calls false [D&O Diary, 2026-08-02](#).
3. The price is about 108 times expected profit, and the average analyst target sits below Friday's close (MarketBeat, tier 3, unverified).

Thesis check Watch - no written thesis yet (theses/BE.md); the largest customer project is delayed and a lawsuit is pending, both unresolved.

Coming up Q3 results about 2026-10-27 (not confirmed).

Position: VIAV (Viavi Solutions)

Bottom line: VIAV rose 5.18% on Friday (your 5% rule fired), its 13th higher close in a row, with no company news. About 3.2 of the 5.18 points were VIAVI's own and no reason was published, though optical peers also rose (inference, medium) and call-option buying was heavy (MarketBeat, tier 3; Thesis: Watch).

Where it stands Order for 0.200 shares at about \$47.10, worth \$9.42; not filled yet. Friday +5.18%, week +15.8%. 22% below its 52-week high (\$60.43); typical day 5.6%.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +5.18%, +0.17 points came from the market, +1.8 from chip stocks and +3.2 from VIAVI itself. That is a normal size for this stock (z-score 0.81). A z-score measures how unusual a move is against the stock's usual swings: 0.81 means a bit less than one typical swing, so nothing unusual. No company reason was published.

- Context, not Friday's cause: on Thursday Bernstein started covering optical-networking stocks at Outperform and Coherent launched a new optics platform; Coherent, Lumentum and Ciena rose 7–11% and VIAV 6.8% [Yahoo Finance, 2026-10-01](#).
- Routine annual-meeting papers were filed; the meeting is 2026-11-11 [SEC DEF 14A, 2026-10-02](#).

How this works VIAVI sells test equipment: instruments that check whether networks, fibre links and data-center connections work at full speed, like a mechanic's diagnostic computer for internet cables. Its network test business grew 69% last quarter, about half of it from data centers (research file). Quarterly revenue was \$443.1 million, up 52.5% [VIAVI Q4 FY2026 results, 2026-08-05](#).

Case to stay

1. Revenue +52.5% and above its own guidance (same release).
2. Next quarter guided higher: \$450–460 million (same release).
3. Management aims for \$500 million a quarter during 2027 (research file, from company call).

Case to retreat

1. Three insiders (two directors and an executive) sold about \$4.2 million in August–September without a pre-planned plan (SEC Form 4s, per research file). That would have met your "several insiders" breaker at the time; it is 3–7 weeks old, before today's window.
2. It sold about 12.8 million new shares at \$45 in May, raising the share count about 15% in a year (tier 3) [Investing.com, 2026-08-05](#).
3. After 13 up days in a row, the move rests on momentum (buyers chasing a rising price) and option buying more than on new facts (inference, medium confidence). Call options are contracts that pay off only if the price rises, so heavy buying is a bet on more gains.

Thesis check Watch - no written thesis yet (theses/VIAV.md); past unplanned insider selling and the May share sale (about 15% more shares) are unresolved, the same evidence that puts AXTI on Watch.

Coming up Q1 FY2027 results estimated 2026-10-28 (not confirmed); annual meeting 2026-11-11.

Position: AXTI (AXT Inc)

Bottom line: AXTI rose 4.96% on Friday, mostly because chip stocks rose; there was no company news. Its story is a wafer shortage for AI lasers, with China export permits as the big risk (results confirmed for 2026-10-29; Thesis: Watch).

Where it stands Order for 0.100 shares at about \$85.87, worth \$8.59; not filled yet. Friday +4.96%. Up about 1,700% in a year, yet 40% below its high. It is the most volatile stock you own: a typical day moves it 8.3%, and it fell 74% from May to July.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +4.96%, +1.27 points came from the market, +2.50 from chip stocks and +1.19 from AXT itself (normal size).

- AXT scheduled its third-quarter results for 2026-10-29, after the US close [AXT via Business Wire, 2026-10-01](#).
- Background: China requires export permits for indium phosphide wafers; permits for US customers are still not issued, which AXT calls "the most significant challenge we currently face" [AXT 10-Q, 2026-08-13](#).
- Background: Lumentum (another of your holdings) signed a six-year deal to reserve AXT's production, backed by two \$43.5 million deposits [AXT 8-K, 2026-07-29](#).

How this works AXT makes the thin, flat discs (wafers or "substrates") that lasers are built on, mostly indium phosphide (InP), mainly in China. AI data centers use InP lasers to send data as light, so wafer demand soared. Revenue rose from \$18.0 million to \$47.6 million in a year, and InP was \$30.7 million of that (research file, call transcript).

Case to stay

1. Revenue up about 2.6 times in a year, with a big customer prepaying for capacity (8-K above).
2. Q3 guidance of about \$66 million would be another record (call transcript, tier 3).
3. Few other suppliers can make InP wafers at scale (inference, medium confidence).

Case to retreat

1. China controls the permits; US customers still cannot get them [AXT 10-Q, 2026-08-13](#).
2. In April it sold 8.56 million new shares at \$64.25, raising the share count about 15% [AXT 424B5, 2026-04-21](#).
3. In June the CEO (about \$22.3 million) and three directors sold shares without pre-planned plans [SEC Form 4, 2026-06-03](#). That would have met your "several insiders" breaker at the time.

Thesis check Watch - no written thesis yet (theses/AXTI.md); permit risk, past dilution and past unplanned insider selling are all unresolved.

Coming up Q3 results 2026-10-29 after the close (confirmed).

Position: AAOI (Applied Optoelectronics)

Bottom line: AAOI jumped 7.71% on Friday (your 5% rule fired) and 8.1% on Thursday, with no company news, as optical-networking stocks rose together. It is selling new shares to fund factories, which slowly dilutes owners (Thesis: Watch).

Where it stands Order for 0.070 shares at about \$115.59, worth \$8.09; not filled yet. Friday +7.71%, week +14%. Still 50.5% below its May high of \$233.67; typical day 7.4%; moves about four times as much as the market.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +7.71%, +1.15 points came from the market, +2.60 from chip stocks and +3.96 from AOI itself. For this stock, that company part is normal day-to-day noise (z-score 0.5, half of one typical swing).

- Optical peers rose the same day (Lumentum +3%, Coherent +4%) and no AOI filing or release appeared [24/7 Wall St., 2026-10-02](#).
- Background: in August AOI set up a program to sell up to \$600 million of new shares over time, its third this year. The stock fell 13.8% the next trading day; no reason was published, but more shares mean a smaller slice for each owner (inference, medium confidence) [AOI 8-K, 2026-08-21](#).

How this works AOI makes optical transceivers: plug-in modules that turn a server's electrical signals into laser light and back, at 800 or 1,600 gigabits per second. Think of a translator at each end of a phone line. It also sells cable-TV amplifiers. Last quarter revenue was a record \$191.9 million (+86.4%); data centers were 56.1% [AOI Q2 2026 results, 2026-08-06](#).

Case to stay

1. Five record quarters in a row and its first adjusted profit (same release).
2. Building factories for about 650,000 high-speed units a month by end-2026 [AOI Q2 2026 results, 2026-08-06](#).
3. Q3 guidance \$255–290 million, well above Q2 (same results release).

Case to retreat

1. Shares outstanding rose from 75.0 million to 84.4 million in six months, and up to \$600 million more may be sold [AOI 10-Q, 2026-08-06](#).
2. Its top 10 customers are 99% of revenue. Customers owe AOI \$314.0 million for goods already

delivered (receivables), and one distributor owes \$211.0 million of that (same 10-Q).

3. Still loses money under standard accounting (GAAP net loss \$22.8 million last quarter) and fell 67% from May to July.

Thesis check Watch - no written thesis yet (theses/AAOI.md); ongoing dilution and extreme customer concentration.

Coming up Q3 results estimated 2026-11-05 (not announced).

Position: FORM (FormFactor)

Bottom line: FORM barely moved on Friday (+0.48%) while chip stocks rose; its own small dip was normal noise and no reason was published. It is up 54% in a month, partly on AI chip-testing optimism (Deutsche Bank's note; part unexplained), and moves to a bigger S&P index on Tuesday 2026-10-06; thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.050 shares at about \$149.15, worth \$7.46; not filled yet. Friday +0.48%. 7% below its 52-week high; RSI (a 0–100 gauge of how fast a stock has risen) is 72.8. Above 70 means a very fast recent climb.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +0.48%, about 0 came from the market, +2.72 from chip stocks and -2.24 from FormFactor itself (normal size).

- S&P moves FormFactor from the SmallCap 600 into the MidCap 400 index before the open on 2026-10-06, replacing Twilio. These are S&P's lists of small and medium-sized US companies. Index funds that copy each list will rebalance (sell or buy to match the new list) at Monday's close, because that is the last price before the change [S&P Dow Jones Indices, 2026-10-01](#).
- Background (tier-3 sources only): on 2026-09-30 Deutsche Bank began coverage positively, saying FormFactor is now a second approved supplier of test cards for NVIDIA graphics chips; the stock rose 9.6% [Investing.com, 2026-09-30](#).

How this works Before chips are cut from a wafer, each one is tested by touching it with thousands of tiny needles on a "probe card". FormFactor makes those cards, especially for high-bandwidth memory used in AI. A card is custom-made per chip design and wears out, so demand repeats. Q2 revenue was a record \$258.2 million (+31.9%) [FormFactor Q2 2026 results, 2026-07-29](#).

Case to stay

1. Record revenue and adjusted margin (53.3%); Q3 guided to \$270 million ± \$10 million (same release).
2. Memory makers report booming AI-memory sales. Micron's quarterly revenue was \$54.23 billion against \$51.07 billion expected. A +343% figure for DRAM (computers' main working memory) seen in a CNBC summary could not be verified [Micron 8-K, 2026-09-30](#).
3. Moving up to the MidCap 400 reflects its growth. The effect on demand for the shares is unclear, because SmallCap funds sell as MidCap funds buy (S&P release above; inference).

Case to retreat

1. Management says about a third of Q2's margin gain was one-off (tariff refunds, recovering metal from scrap), so margins may slip (research file, call transcript).
2. One customer, SK hynix, was 24.3% of revenue (research file, 10-Q).
3. It already trades above the average analyst target (\$138.63, tier 3) after a 54% month.

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/FORM.md).

Coming up Joins S&P MidCap 400 before the open on Tuesday 2026-10-06 (confirmed); Q3 results about 2026-10-28 (estimated).

Position: AMD (Advanced Micro Devices)

Bottom line: AMD rose 2.95% to a record close on Friday, almost all because the market and chip stocks rose. The real news came on 2026-09-28, when it agreed to buy the AI lab World Labs for about \$8.2 billion in shares; thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.010 shares at about \$633.91, worth \$6.34; not filled yet. Friday +2.95%; up 191% in six months; 1.8% below its 52-week high.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +2.95%, +0.89 points came from the market, +1.94 from chip stocks and +0.12 from AMD itself.

- Chip stocks extended their run (Arm +8%, NVIDIA +2%) [24/7 Wall St., 2026-10-02](#).
- AMD agreed to buy World Labs, Fei-Fei Li's AI lab, paying only in AMD shares. The stock fell 3.6% that day; no reason was published in our sources [SEC 8-K, 2026-09-28](#).

How this works AMD designs processors (CPUs, the general-purpose "brains" of computers) and graphics processors (GPUs, chips that do many small calculations at once, ideal for AI). TSMC manufactures them. Data-center revenue was \$6.7 billion last quarter, up 107%, on AI demand [AMD Q2 2026 results, 2026-08-04](#). In July, Anthropic (the maker of Claude, the AI that wrote this report) agreed to deploy up to 2 gigawatts of AMD GPUs (research file).

Case to stay

1. Revenue \$11.5 billion (+50%), data center +107% (same release).
2. Large multi-year AI customer deals, measured in gigawatts (GW) of chips: OpenAI 6 GW in 2025; Anthropic 2 GW in 2026 (research file).
3. Q3 guided to about \$13.0 billion, +41% (same release).

Case to retreat

1. Up 191% in six months and about 69% above its 200-day average, so expectations are high. It fell 7% after a strong report in August (data/metrics; research file).
2. Sales of Helios racks (AMD's complete cabinets of AI servers) only start ramping in late 2026. AMD has also pledged up to \$5 billion of investment in Anthropic, one of its own customers (research file).
3. Paying for World Labs in shares dilutes owners by about 0.8% (researcher's calculation from the 8-K and Q2 share count); CEO Lisa Su also sold about \$48.1 million under a pre-planned plan (Form 4, per research file).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/AMD.md).

Coming up Lisa Su's keynote at the OCP summit 2026-10-12 (confirmed); Q3 results about 2026-11-03 (estimated).

Position: A (Agilent Technologies)

Bottom line: Agilent, your least tech-like and calmest holding, rose 0.66% on Friday with no company news. It is up 28% in three months after two results that beat forecasts; thesis check: no breaker found (no written thesis yet).

Where it stands Order for 0.030 shares at about \$167.78, worth \$5.03; not filled yet. Friday +0.66%. 5% below its 52-week high; typical day 2.9%; moves less than the market (beta 0.84).

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +0.66%, +1.07 points came from the market, -0.62 from health-care stocks and +0.21 from Agilent itself.

- No material news. The past week's -2.9% was mostly health-care stocks falling; no reason for that sector fall was found.
- Background: last quarter revenue was \$1.88 billion and adjusted profit per share \$1.62, both above forecasts; the yearly forecast was raised [Agilent Q3 FY2026 results, 2026-08-26](#).

How this works Agilent sells laboratory instruments, like the machines drug companies use to check what is in a sample, plus the supplies and service they need. Drug makers are replacing ageing machines, and weight-loss (GLP-1) drug work grew 70% or more (research file, call). About \$1.9 billion of sales a quarter.

Case to stay

1. Two beats and two raised forecasts in a row (release above).
2. Customer orders have exceeded shipments for 10 quarters (research file, company call).
3. A different industry from your other holdings: its price moved almost independently of your chip stocks (60-day correlations near zero, data/metrics/portfolio).

Case to retreat

1. UBS lowered its rating to Neutral with a \$165 price target, below Friday's close [TipRanks / The Fly, 2026-09-09](#).
2. \$0.06 of last quarter's profit per share was a one-time tariff refund (release above).
3. Growth is modest (+7.3% "core", which leaves out currency swings and acquisitions), so the price depends on steady execution (inference).

Thesis check No breaker found - there is no written thesis to test yet (add your reasons to theses/A.md).

Coming up Dividend record date 2026-10-06, 25.5 cents a share, paid 2026-10-28. A dividend is cash a company pays its owners; you must own the shares on the record date to receive it [Agilent, 2026-09-16](#): your 0.03 shares would earn under 1 cent, and only if the trade settles in time. Q4 results late November (not confirmed).

Position: CRDO (Credo Technology)

Bottom line: CRDO rose 4.03% on Friday, mostly because chip stocks rose; there was no company news, only scheduled insider sales. It is 29% below its June high after falling about 20% in one day on 2026-09-02 despite beating forecasts (Thesis: Watch).

Where it stands Order for 0.020 shares at about \$218.64, worth \$4.37 (your smallest); not filled yet. Friday +4.03%; typical day 6.5%; moves over three times as much as the market.

What happened, and why *Market vs company:* of Friday's +4.03%, +0.78 points came from the market, +2.21 from chip stocks and +1.04 from Credo itself (normal size).

- The chief operating officer (COO) sold 50,000 shares (about \$10.3 million) under a pre-planned 10b5-1 plan [SEC Form 4, 2026-10-02](#).
- Background: on 2026-09-01 Credo beat forecasts (revenue \$479.0 million, +114.7%), but its standard gross margin fell to 64.5% from 68.2%. The stock fell about 20% the next day. No single published cause was found; the margin drop is the likely candidate (inference, medium confidence) [Credo Q1](#)

[FY2027 results, 2026-09-01.](#)

How this works Credo makes active electrical cables (AECs, copper cables with a small chip inside each end that cleans up the signal, so it can travel further) and chips for optical links. They connect servers and switches inside AI data centers. Four customers were 84% of revenue (33/28/13/10%) (research file, from the 10-Q).

Case to stay

1. Revenue more than doubled and next quarter is guided to \$525–535 million (release above).
2. Full-year growth guided above 85% (same release).
3. Expanding into optical chips through its DustPhotonics purchase [Credo via Business Wire, 2026-05-27.](#)

Case to retreat

1. Four customers are 84% of revenue; losing one would hurt badly (10-Q, per research file).
2. Insiders sold about \$41.5 million between 2026-09-23 and 2026-10-02 and bought nothing (all flagged as pre-planned) (research file).
3. Three banks cut their price targets after the September results (BofA, JPMorgan, Mizuho), though none lowered its rating (research file).

Thesis check Watch - no written thesis yet (theses/CRDO.md); the gross-margin drop (68.2% to 64.5%) and four customers at 84% of revenue are unresolved; insider sales were all pre-planned, so they are not your breaker.

Coming up Q2 FY2027 results about 2026-12-02 (not confirmed).

Your portfolio as a whole

The plan: \$197.35 across 16 stocks, if every order fills near Friday's prices. Biggest weights: ASML 13.2%, PANW 10.2%, CRWD 10.1%, LITE 9.9%, MRNA 9.6%. No single stock dominates. Because the weights are fairly even, the portfolio behaves like about 12.6 equal-sized positions (out of 16 possible) (data/metrics/portfolio-2026-10-04.json).

Concentration in one story: about \$6.20 of every \$10 (62.3%) rides on AI data-center spending (ASML, LITE, TSM, STRL, AMD, BE, CRDO, AAOI, AXTI, VIAV, FORM). Within that, chips and optics move together strongly: over the past 60 days, LITE and AAOI, and LITE and VIAV, both had a correlation of 0.84 (1.0 = move in lockstep). CRWD and PANW move almost as one (0.91). Your two health-care stocks barely move with the rest.

Typical bad day: on 1 day in 20, this mix lost about 4.7% or more over the past year. That is about **\$9.29** on \$197.35 (called one-day 95% value at risk). If the whole market fell 5%, history suggests this portfolio would fall about 11.9%, roughly **\$23.50**, because it moves about 2.4 times as much as the market (beta 2.38). Its worst fall over the past year, held as-is, would have been 24%.

Against your goals You want to diversify beyond tech: today 78.3% of your money is in technology companies, 12.2% in health care (MRNA, A) and 9.5% in industrials (STRL, BE), and 62.3% rides on AI data centers. You want it reasonably safe: its yearly volatility (how bumpy the ride is) is about 45%, roughly four times the S&P 500's recent level (about 11%), and it moves about 2.4 times as much as the market. You want some high movers: 12 of 16 stocks (71.9% of the money) move at least 1.5 times as much as the market. AAOI, AXTI, VIAV, FORM and ASML were not in config/portfolio.toml; the routine added them today so they count in these numbers.

Next 14 days:

Date	Event
Mon 2026-10-05	Your 16 market orders should fill at the open (15:30 Madrid)
2026-10-06	FORM joins S&P MidCap 400 (confirmed); Agilent dividend record date
2026-10-08	TSMC September sales
2026-10-09	MRNA joins the Nasdaq-100 (confirmed)
2026-10-12 to 10-15	OCP Global Summit: AMD keynote 10-12, Lumentum talks 10-14
2026-10-13	Snowflake court filing deadline; FormFactor CEO at an investor summit
2026-10-14	ASML Q3 results, before the US open
2026-10-15	TSMC Q3 results, 2:00 a.m. US Eastern
Just after	MRNA melanoma data 10-24; BE ~10-27; VIAV, FORM ~10-28; AXTI 10-29 (confirmed); MRNA ~10-29

Lesson of the day

Why won't your weekend orders fill at Friday's price?

Your sheet lists 16 orders dated Monday 5 October, each with an "entry price" that is really Friday's closing price. US stock markets are closed at weekends, so nothing trades until Monday at 9:30 a.m. New York time (15:30 in Madrid).

A **market order** says "fill my order right away, at whatever the price is." When the market opens, your order fills at the first available price. That can be higher or lower than Friday's close, because weekend news changes what buyers and sellers will pay. A **limit order** says "buy only at this price or better." It protects you from a surprise price, but it may never fill if the stock runs away from your limit.

Worked example: your sheet assumes Lumentum (LITE) at \$1,085.42, so 0.018 shares cost \$19.54. If LITE opens 3% higher on Monday, at about \$1,117.98, the same 0.018 shares cost about \$20.12: 58 cents more before the market has done anything "to" you. That is why the report shows zero profit or loss today: you do not own these shares yet. Once you know your real Fidelity fill prices, type them into column Q of your sheet so the report can measure from the price you actually paid.

Check yourself: ASML's typical daily swing is about 2.7% of its price. If ASML opens 2.7% below Friday's \$1,867.31, roughly what would your 0.014 shares cost? (Answer at the end.)

New words today

- **Guidance:** a company's own forecast of its future sales or profit; markets react to it more than to last quarter's results.
- **Consensus:** the average forecast of the analysts who follow a company; "beating" means doing better than it.
- **EPS (earnings per share):** a company's profit divided by its number of shares, i.e. your slice of the profit for each share.
- **Gross margin:** what is left of each dollar of sales after paying to make the product; 54% means 54 cents of every dollar.
- **Operating margin:** what is left after also paying for research, sales and offices.

- **P/E (price-to-earnings)**: share price divided by yearly EPS, i.e. how many years of today's profit you pay for. 60 means 60 years' worth.
- **GAAP / non-GAAP**: GAAP is the official accounting rulebook; "non-GAAP" or "adjusted" numbers leave some costs out and usually look better.
- **Market cap**: share price times the number of shares, which is what the market says the whole company is worth.
- **Backlog**: signed orders not yet delivered, i.e. work already lined up.
- **Capex**: money spent on long-lasting things like factories and machines.
- **ETF**: a fund that holds a basket of stocks and trades like one share; SMH holds chip companies and is used here as "the chip industry".
- **Beta**: how much a stock tends to move when the market moves; 2 means about twice as much.
- **Volatility**: how bumpy a stock's ride is; higher means bigger daily swings, both ways.
- **Correlation**: how closely two stocks move together, from -1 (opposite) to 1 (in lockstep).
- **Drawdown**: a fall from a previous high, e.g. "down 54% at its worst".
- **Moving average**: the average price over the last 50 or 200 days; being above it is read as an uptrend.
- **RSI**: a 0–100 gauge of how fast a stock has risen or fallen lately; above 70 means a very fast rise.
- **Value at risk (VaR)**: a loss that is exceeded only on the worst 1 day in 20, based on past behaviour.
- **8-K / 10-Q / 10-K**: US company filings: an 8-K reports an important event, a 10-Q is the quarterly report, a 10-K the annual report.
- **Form 4 / Form 144**: filings showing that an insider (director or officer) traded shares, or plans to sell.
- **10b5-1**: a pre-planned trading schedule an insider sets months ahead, so a sale under it says little about today's view.
- **Dilution**: when a company creates new shares, so each existing share owns a smaller slice.
- **Buyback**: when a company buys its own shares, so each remaining share owns a bigger slice.
- **Export controls**: government rules about what may be sold to which countries.
- **ARR (annual recurring revenue)**: the yearly value of the subscriptions customers have signed.
- **Net new ARR**: how much ARR grew during one quarter, after subtracting customers who left.
- **Net revenue retention**: what last year's customers spend this year, compared with last year; 126% means they spend 26% more.
- **Free cash flow**: cash left over after paying the bills and investing in equipment, i.e. money the company could hand back or save.
- **GPU**: a graphics processor, a chip that does many small calculations at once, which suits AI.
- **Hyperscaler**: the giant cloud companies (Amazon, Microsoft, Google, Meta, Oracle) that build the biggest data centers.
- **Active electrical cable**: a copper cable with a small chip at each end that strengthens the signal so it travels further.
- **Optical transceiver**: a plug-in module that turns electrical signals into light for fibre-optic cables, and back.
- **Attribution (market vs company)**: splitting a day's move into the part from the whole market, the part from the stock's industry, and the part from the company itself.
- **Z-score**: how unusual a move is compared with the stock's normal swings; 1 means one typical swing, and only values well above 2 are rare.
- **52-week high**: the highest price a stock reached in the past year.
- **Thesis / breaker**: your thesis is your written reason for owning a stock; a breaker is an event you listed that would make you re-check it.
- **Stop-loss / target**: prices you set in advance to be alerted if a stock falls (stop-loss) or rises (target) that far.
- **Price target**: the price an analyst expects a stock to reach in about a year; an opinion, not a fact.
- **Analyst rating / downgrade**: an analyst's label (Buy, Outperform, Neutral, Equal-Weight, Sell); a downgrade lowers it.
- **Convertible bonds (convertible notes)**: loans to a company that the lender can later swap for shares, which can dilute owners.

- **Capped call:** a side deal with banks that cancels out the new shares from convertible bonds, up to a ceiling price.
- **Shelf filing (S-3):** a registration that lets a company sell new shares quickly whenever it chooses.
- **Securities class action:** a group lawsuit by shareholders who say the company misled them.
- **Force majeure:** a contract clause that excuses delays caused by events outside a party's control.
- **Index fund / rebalance:** a fund that automatically owns every stock in a list (an index); it rebalances by buying and selling when the list changes.
- **Nasdaq-100, S&P 500, MidCap 400, SmallCap 600:** well-known lists (indexes) of companies that many funds copy.
- **Phase 3:** the final, largest round of patient testing before a medicine can be approved.
- **Foundry:** a factory that manufactures chips designed by other companies.
- **Lithography / EUV:** printing circuit patterns onto silicon with light; EUV (extreme ultraviolet) is the most advanced kind.
- **Call option:** a contract that pays off only if a stock rises above a set price.
- **Momentum:** buyers chasing a price because it has been rising.
- **After hours:** trading after the regular 4 p.m. New York close.
- **Operating cash flow:** cash brought in by the day-to-day business.
- **Receivables:** money customers owe for goods already delivered.
- **Net cash:** more cash than debt.
- **Dividend / record date:** cash a company pays its owners; you must own shares on the record date to get it.
- **Fiscal year (FY):** a company's own accounting year, which need not match the calendar.
- **Tier 1 / 2 / 3 sources:** tier 1 is the company or regulator itself, tier 2 established newsrooms, tier 3 secondary sites to confirm before relying on.

Data quality and sources

- **Holdings:** read from your FIDELITY sheet ("Trades" tab) with the Google Drive connector, read only, at about 15:50 UTC on 2026-10-04. All 16 rows are open market orders dated 2026-10-05 (in the future), with no fill price, stop-loss or target filled in, so entry prices are Friday-close estimates and profit and loss (P&L) is zero. The ticker "A " had a trailing space in the sheet; the pipeline read it as A.
- **Pipeline:** every step ran (holdings, prices, metrics, attribution, portfolio risk, rules, SEC filings, fundamentals). AAOI, AXTI, VIAV, FORM and ASML were missing from config/portfolio.toml; the routine added their sector, theme and industry fund (SMH) and created empty thesis files for them, then re-ran the pipeline.
- **Research:** one researcher per holding (16). The session's web-search allowance (200 searches) ran out partway through. Later checks used direct page reads, so some causes rest on tier-3 sources, labelled where used. Several CNBC, Bloomberg and Reuters pages blocked direct reading; those points rely on search summaries and are marked.
- **CrowdStrike:** its researcher saved its file, then stopped on a rate limit before reporting back; the section uses that file.
- **Citations:** some points cite "(research file)": the fact sits in data/research/2026-10-04/<TICKER>.json with its original source, but the source was not re-linked here, so treat those as one step less checked.
- **Not confirmed:** most earnings dates are estimates (only TSMC 10-15, AXT 10-29 and ASML 10-14 are company- or exchange-confirmed, and ASML's only via third parties). The status of the US MATCH Act could not be confirmed from a primary source.
- **No written theses:** "Why I own it" is still TODO for every holding, so thesis checks are judged against each company's own plans.
- **Prices:** Yahoo Finance (via the pipeline). Filings: SEC EDGAR. Fundamentals: SEC XBRL company facts. Market-vs-company splits: data/metrics/attribution-2026-10-04.json.

- Answer to "check yourself": $\$1,867.31 \times (1 - 0.027) \approx \$1,816.89$ a share; $\times 0.014 \approx \mathbf{\$25.44}$, about 70 cents less than the \$26.14 your sheet shows.

Informational research and education, not investment advice. The decisions are yours.